Healthy Lifestyle Guide
Physical Activity and Exercise
Regular physical activity is one of the most important things you can do for your health. It can help control weight, reduce the risk of chronic diseases, improve mental health, and strengthen bones and muscles.
Recommended Physical Activity Levels
Adults (18-64 years):
- At least 150-300 minutes of moderate-intensity aerobic activity per week, OR
- 75-150 minutes of vigorous-intensity aerobic activity per week
- Muscle-strengthening activities for all major muscle groups at least 2 days per week
- Reduce sedentary behavior and break up long periods of sitting
Older Adults (65+):
- Same as adults, plus activities that improve balance and prevent falls
- Adjust intensity based on fitness level and health conditions
Children and Adolescents (6-17 years):
- At least 60 minutes of moderate-to-vigorous physical activity daily
- Include muscle-strengthening and bone-strengthening activities at least 3 days per week
Types of Exercise
- **Aerobic/Cardio**: Walking, running, cycling, swimming, dancing · improves heart and lung health
- **Strength training**: Weight lifting, resistance bands, bodyweight exercises · builds muscle and bone strength
- **Flexibility**: Stretching, yoga · improves range of motion and reduces injury risk
- **Balance**: Tai chi, single-leg stands · reduces fall risk, especially for older adults
Getting Started Safely
- Start slowly and gradually increase intensity and duration
- Warm up before exercise and cool down afterward
- Stay hydrated during physical activity
- Wear appropriate footwear and clothing
- Listen to your body and rest when needed
- Consult a healthcare provider before starting a new exercise program if you have health concerns
Source: WHO Physical Activity Guidelines, CDC, American College of Sports Medicine
Weight Management
Maintaining a healthy weight is important for overall health and reduces the risk of chronic diseases including heart disease, diabetes, and certain cancers.
Understanding BMI
Body Mass Index (BMI) is a general indicator of body fat:
- Underweight: BMI below 18.5
- Normal weight: BMI 18.5-24.9
- Overweight: BMI 25.0-29.9
- Obese: BMI 30.0 and above
Note: BMI is a screening tool, not a diagnostic tool. It doesn't account for muscle mass, bone density, or fat distribution.
Healthy Weight Management Tips
- Focus on sustainable lifestyle changes, not quick fixes
- Eat a balanced diet with appropriate portion sizes
- Increase physical activity gradually
- Set realistic goals (0.5-1 kg/1-2 lbs per week for weight loss)
- Keep a food and activity journal
- Get adequate sleep (poor sleep affects hunger hormones)
- Manage stress (stress can lead to emotional eating)
- Seek support from healthcare providers or registered dietitians
Source: CDC, NIH, WHO
Substance Use and Health
Tobacco and Smoking
- Smoking is the leading cause of preventable death worldwide
- It increases risk of lung cancer, heart disease, stroke, and respiratory diseases
- Secondhand smoke is also harmful

- Quitting at any age provides significant health benefits
- Resources for quitting: nicotine replacement therapy, counseling, quit lines
Alcohol
- If consumed, limit intake (up to 1 drink/day for women, 2 for men)
- Excessive drinking increases risk of liver disease, heart disease, and certain cancers
- Some people should not drink at all: pregnant women, people taking certain medications, those with liver disease
Caffeine
- Moderate caffeine intake (up to 400mg/day, about 4 cups of coffee) is generally safe for most adults
- Excessive caffeine can cause anxiety, insomnia, and digestive issues
- Pregnant women should limit to 200mg/day
- Be aware of caffeine in energy drinks, sodas, and medications
Source: WHO, CDC, NIH
Skin Health and Sun Protection
Sun Safety
- Use broad-spectrum sunscreen with SPF 30 or higher
- Reapply sunscreen every 2 hours and after swimming or sweating
- Seek shade during peak sun hours (10 AM - 4 PM)
- Wear protective clothing, wide-brimmed hats, and UV-blocking sunglasses
- Avoid tanning beds
General Skin Care
- Keep skin clean and moisturized
- Stay hydrated for skin health
- Eat a diet rich in vitamins A, C, and E
- Perform regular skin self-examinations for changes in moles or new growths
- See a dermatologist for annual skin checks
Source: American Academy of Dermatology, CDC, WHO
Ergonomics and Posture
For Office Workers
- Position your screen at eye level, about arm's length away
- Keep feet flat on the floor or on a footrest
- Maintain a 90-degree angle at elbows when typing
- Take breaks every 30-60 minutes to stand, stretch, and walk
- Use a supportive chair with proper lumbar support
Reducing Eye Strain (20-20-20 Rule)
- Every 20 minutes, look at something 20 feet away for 20 seconds
- Adjust screen brightness to match surroundings
- Blink frequently to prevent dry eyes
- Consider blue-light filtering glasses if working long hours on screens
Source: Occupational Safety and Health Administration (OSHA), American Optometric Association